

VPA ICT — IGCSE Y9S1 Assessment Pack

IGCSE ICT Year 9 Semester 1 Assessment Pack

Syllabus: CIE IGCSE ICT (0417) Paper 1 — Theory | Duration: 2 hours (full paper) / 40 minutes (class tests)

Assessment Structure

Assessment	Format	Timing	Marks
Weekly Quizzes	10 MCQs + 2 short answer	15 min	20
Topic Tests	Past paper questions (topic-specific)	40 min	40
Mid-Semester Mock	Half Paper 1 (Topics 1 – 4)	1 hour	50
End-of-Semester Mock	Full Paper 1 (all topics)	2 hours	100

Mark Scheme Guidance for Teachers

IGCSE uses three types of marks:

A marks: Accuracy — correct answer

M marks: Method — correct method even if calculation error

B marks: Independent — standalone marks for correct statements

Paper 1 Command Words

Command	What Students Must Do	Example
State	Give a brief answer, no explanation needed	"State two input devices"
Describe	Give a detailed account with features	"Describe how a laser printer works"
Explain	Give reasons or causes, show how/why	"Explain why a SSD is faster than a HDD"
Compare	Identify similarities AND differences	"Compare star and bus topologies"
Discuss	Give balanced arguments for and against	"Discuss the effects of teleworking"
Suggest	Apply knowledge to a new scenario	"Suggest a suitable device for a warehouse"

Sample Mark Scheme: 6-Mark "Discuss" Question

Question: "Discuss the effects of increased ICT use on employment." [6 marks]

Mark Scheme (B marks):

Job creation in tech sectors (1 mark)

Job displacement through automation (1 mark)

Need for retraining/reskilling (1 mark)

New types of jobs (e.g., data analyst, UX designer) (1 mark)

Reduction in manual/repetitive jobs (1 mark)

Global outsourcing opportunities (1 mark)

Balanced conclusion with justification (1 mark — any 6 points)

Bilingual Assessment Support

Key terms tests: English term → Chinese definition, and vice versa

Sentence frames for "explain":

"This is because..." / "这是因为... (zhè shì yīnwèi...)"

"One reason is... Another reason is..." / "一个原因是... 另一个原因是..."

"For example,..." / "例如, ... (lìrú, ...)"

Past paper annotations: Chinese summaries of question requirements

Visual mark schemes: Diagram-based marking for hardware questions

Accommodation for EAL Students

Need	Accommodation
Reading speed	+15 minutes for paper-based tests
Vocabulary	Bilingual glossary permitted during tests
Writing	Can use bullet points instead of prose for "explain" questions (up to 70% of marks)
Comprehension	Teacher reads questions aloud; students may ask for clarification

Revision Resources

- ☐ Topic revision cards (1 per syllabus point)
- ☐ Past paper question bank (2018–2024) organized by topic
- ☐ Quizlet flashcard sets for all vocabulary
- ☐ Bilingual glossary (200 terms)
- ☐ Model answer bank for 4-mark and 6-mark questions
- ☐ Practice trace tables for algorithm questions